

# Chapter Three: Group Behavior



# Chapter Outline

- Nature and definition of Group
- Types of groups
- Stages of group development
- Group task and productivity
- How group control their members
- Group vs team
- Group Decision Making

# Defining and Classifying Groups

*Any numbers of people who:*

- ✓ *interact with one another*
- ✓ *are psychologically aware of one another; and*
- ✓ *perceive themselves to be a group*

# Defining and Classifying Groups(cont'd)

## **Group(s)**

Two or more individuals interacting and interdependent, who have come together to achieve particular objectives.

---

### **Formal Group**

A designated work group defined by the organization's structure.

### **Informal Group**

A group that is neither formally structured nor organizationally determined; appears in response to the need for social contact.

# Defining and Classifying Groups (cont'd)

## **Command Group**

A group composed of the individuals who report directly to a given manager.

---

## **Interest Group**

Those working together to attain a specific objective with which each is concerned.

## **Task Group**

Those working together to complete a job or task.

---

## **Friendship Group**

Those brought together because they share one or more common characteristics.

# Why People Join Groups

- Security
- Status
- Self-esteem
- Affiliation
- Power
- Goal Achievement



# The Five-Stage Model of Group Development

## **Forming Stage**

The first stage in group development, characterized by much uncertainty.

---

## **Storming Stage**

The second stage in group development, characterized by intragroup conflict.

---

## **Norming Stage**

The third stage in group development, characterized by close relationships and cohesiveness.



## ...Group Development (cont'd)

### **Performing Stage**

The fourth stage in group development, when the group is fully functional.

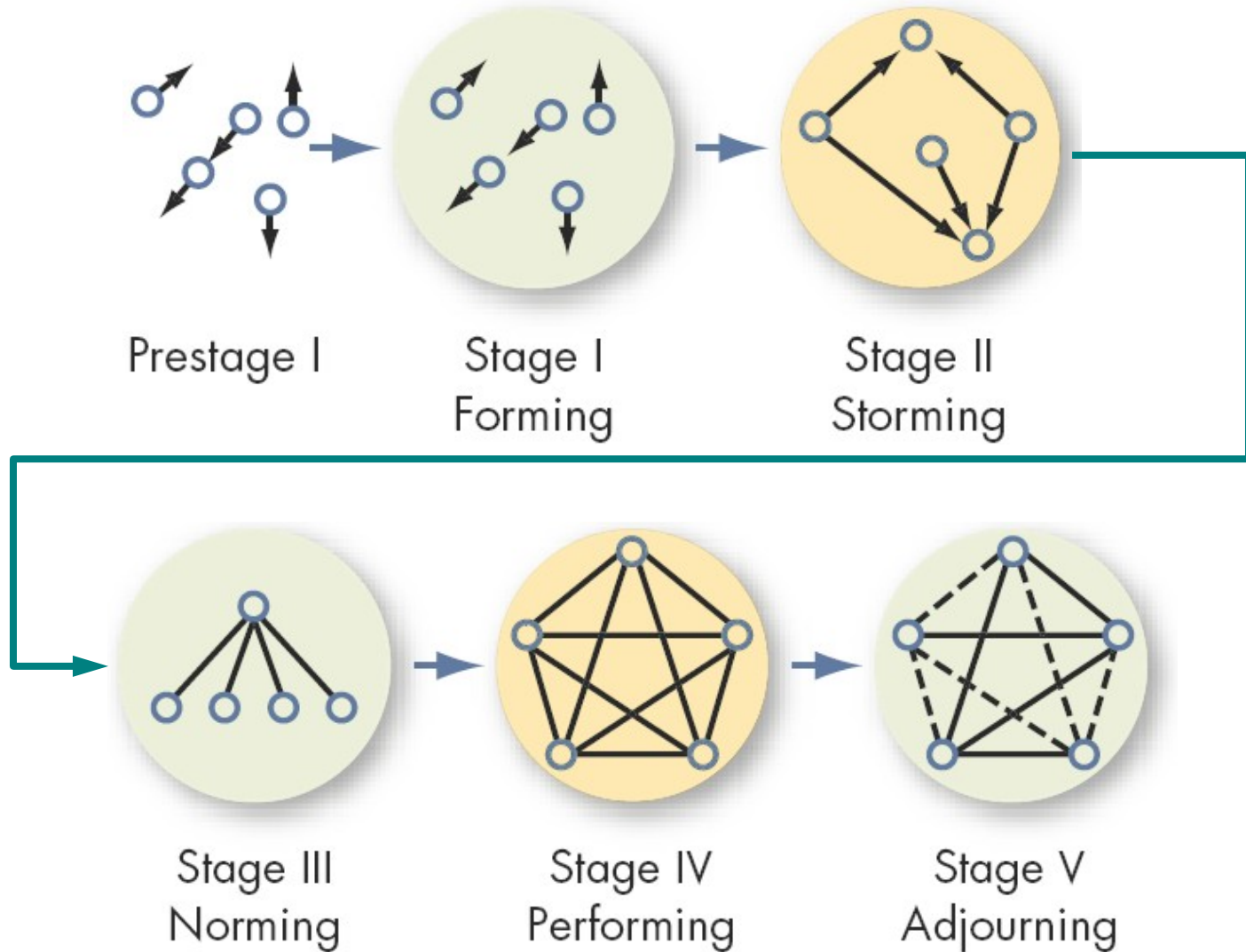
---

### **Adjourning Stage**

The final stage in group development for temporary groups, characterized by concern with wrapping up activities rather than performance.



# Stages of Group Development



## Group Task and Productivity

- People can be more productive when working in groups than when working alone, if the obstacles to group productivity are avoided
- **Synergy**- the whole is more than the sum of its parts ( $2 + 2 > 4$ )
- **Process loss**- is the difference between what is actually produced by a group and what could have been produced by the group when you consider its inputs ( $2 + 2 < 4$ )

# *How Groups Control Their Members?*

## *Group structure:*

- ✓ *Rules*
- ✓ *Roles*
- ✓ *Norms*
- ✓ *Status*
- ✓ *Size*
- ✓ *Composition*
- ✓ *Cohesiveness*

# Group Structure – Roles

## **Role(s)**

A set of expected behavior patterns attributed to someone occupying a given position in a social unit.

---

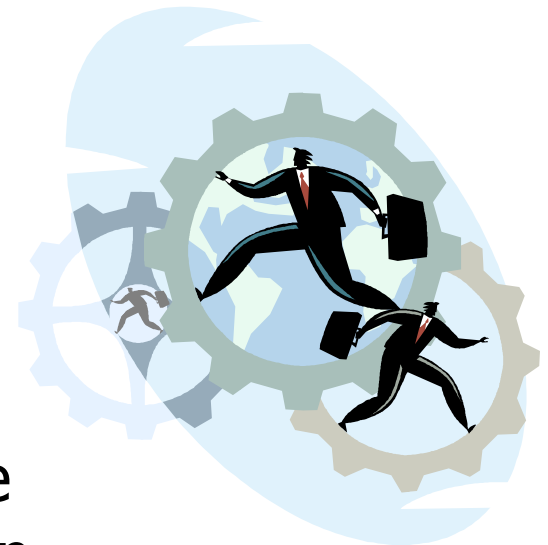
## **Role Identity**

Certain attitudes and behaviors consistent with a role.

---

## **Role Perception**

An individual's view of how he or she is supposed to act in a given situation.



# Group Structure - Roles (cont'd)

## Role Expectations

How others believe a person should act in a given situation.

---

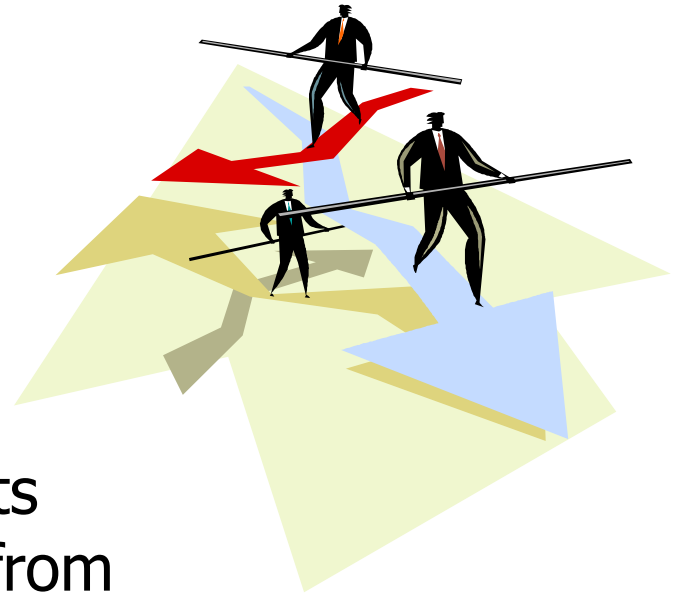
## Psychological Contract

An unwritten agreement that sets out what management expects from the employee and vice versa.

---

## Role Conflict

A situation in which an individual is confronted by divergent role expectations.



# Group Structure - Norms

## **Norms**

Acceptable standards of behavior within a group that are shared by the group's members.

### **Classes of Norms:**

- **Performance norms**
- **Appearance norms**
- **Social arrangement norms**
- **Allocation of resources norms**

# The Hawthorne Studies

- **A series of studies undertaken by Elton Mayo at Western Electric Company's Hawthorne Works in Chicago between 1924 and 1932.**
- **Research Conclusions:**
  - Worker behavior and sentiments were closely related.
  - Group influences (norms) were significant in affecting individual behavior.
  - Group standards (norms) were highly effective in establishing individual worker output.
  - Money was less a factor in determining worker output than were group standards, sentiments, and security.

# Group Structure - Norms (cont'd)

## Conformity

Adjusting one's behavior to align with the norms of the group.

---

## Reference Groups

Important groups to which individuals belong or hope to belong and with whose norms individuals are likely to conform.



# Group Structure - Norms (cont'd)

## Deviant Workplace Behavior

Antisocial actions by organizational members that intentionally violate established norms and result in negative consequences for the organization, its members, or both.



# Typology of Deviant Workplace Behavior

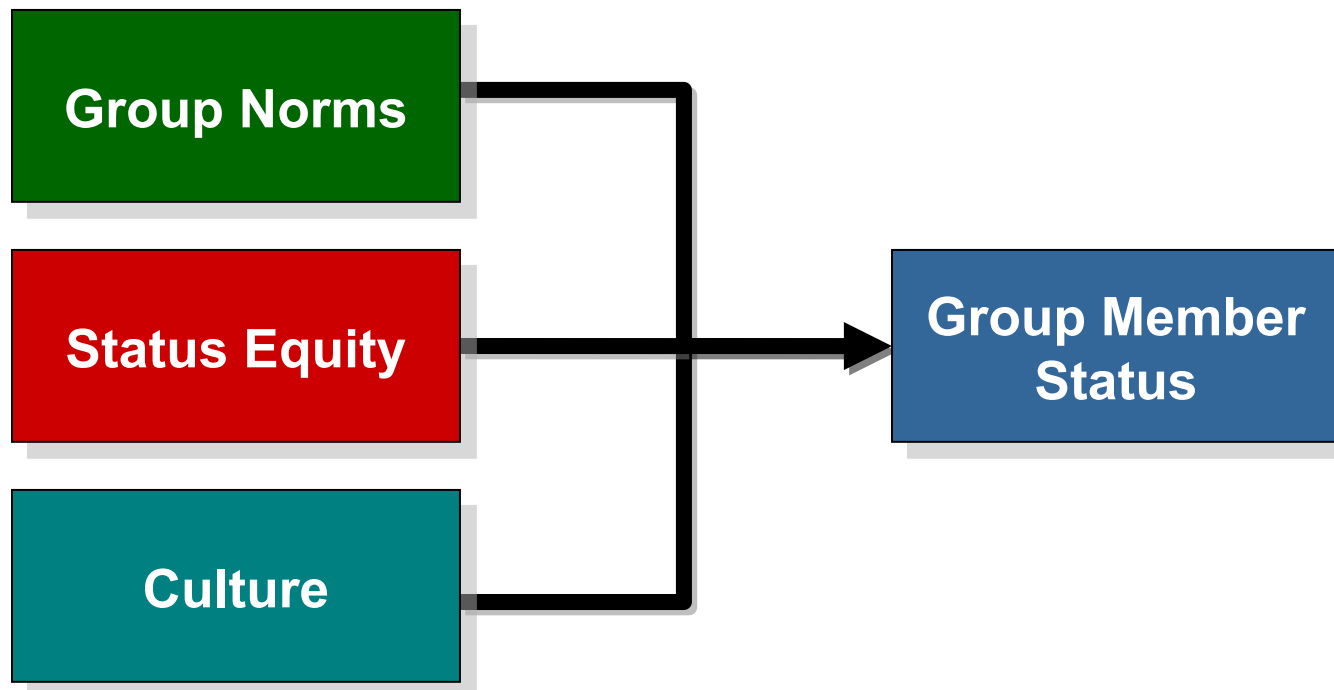
| Category            | Examples                                                                  |
|---------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Production          | Leaving early<br>Intentionally working slowly<br>Wasting resources        |
| Property            | Sabotage<br>Lying about hours worked<br>Stealing from the organization    |
| Political           | Showing favoritism<br>Gossiping and spreading rumors<br>Blaming coworkers |
| Personal Aggression | Sexual harassment<br>Verbal abuse<br>Stealing from coworkers              |

Source: Adapted from S.L. Robinson, and R.J. Bennett. "A Typology of Deviant Workplace Behaviors: A Multidimensional Scaling Study," *Academy of Management Journal*, April 1995, p. 565.

# Group Structure - Status

## Status

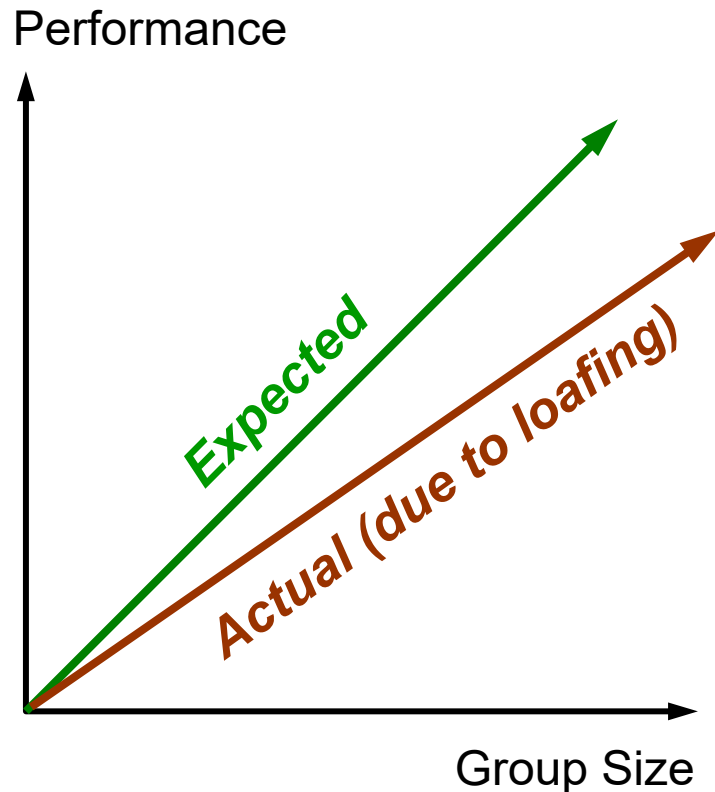
A socially defined position or rank given to groups or group members by others.



# Group Structure - Size

## Social Loafing

The tendency for individuals to expend less effort when working collectively than when working individually.



### Other conclusions:

- Odd number groups do better than even.
- Groups of 7 or 9 perform better overall than larger or smaller groups.

# Group Structure - Composition

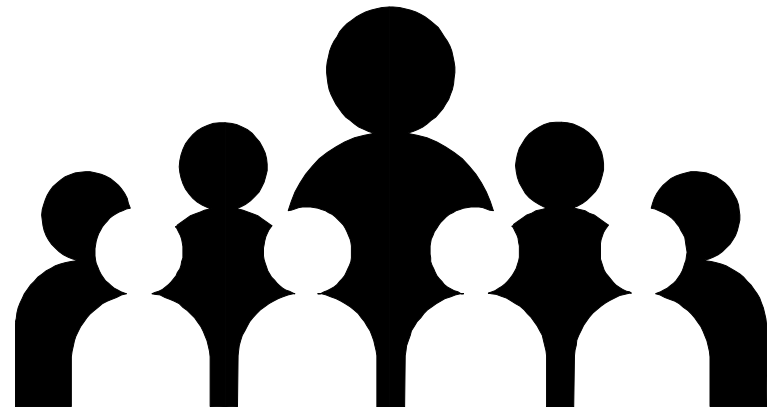
## Group Demography

The degree to which members of a group share a common demographic attribute, such as age, sex, race, educational level, or length of service in the organization, and the impact of this attribute on turnover.

---

## Cohorts

Individuals who, as part of a group, hold a common attribute.



# Group Structure - Cohesiveness

## **Cohesiveness**

Degree to which group members are attracted to each other and are motivated to stay in the group.

### **Increasing group cohesiveness:**

1. Make the group smaller.
2. Encourage agreement with group goals.
3. Increase time members spend together.
4. Increase group status and admission difficulty.
5. Stimulate competition with other groups.
6. Give rewards to the group, not individuals.
7. Physically isolate the group.

# Relationship Between Group Cohesiveness, Performance Norms, and Productivity

|                          |      | <b>Cohesiveness</b> |                              |
|--------------------------|------|---------------------|------------------------------|
|                          |      | High                | Low                          |
| <b>Performance norms</b> | High | High productivity   | Moderate productivity        |
|                          | Low  | Low productivity    | Moderate to low productivity |

# Group Tasks

## ➤ **Decision-making**

- Large groups facilitate the pooling of information about complex tasks.
- Smaller groups are better suited to coordinating and facilitating the implementation of complex tasks.
- Simple, routine standardized tasks reduce the requirement that group processes be effective in order for the group to perform well.

# Group Decision Making

## ➤ **Strengths**

- More time to process information (slower)
- Increased diversity of view form
- Higher quality of decisions (more accuracy)
- Ambiguous and complex solutions

# Group Decision Making (cont'd)

## **Groupthink**

Phenomenon in which the norm for consensus overrides/dominates the realistic appraisal /evaluation/ of alternative course of action.

---

## **Groupshift**

A change in decision risk between the group's decision and the individual decision that member within the group would make; can be either toward conservatism or greater risk.

# Symptoms Of The Groupthink Phenomenon

- **Group members rationalize any resistance to the assumptions they have made.**
- **Members apply direct pressures on those who express doubts about shared views or who question the alternative favored by the majority.**
- **Members who have doubts or differing points of view keep silent about misgivings.**
- **There appears to be an illusion of unanimity.**

# Group Decision-Making Techniques

## **Interacting Groups**

Typical groups, in which the members interact with each other face-to-face.

---

## **Nominal Group Technique**

A group decision-making method in which individual members meet face-to-face to pool their judgments in a systematic but independent fashion.

---



# Group Decision-Making Techniques

## Brainstorming

An idea-generation process that specifically encourages any and all alternatives, while withholding any criticism of those alternatives.

---

## Electronic Meeting

A meeting in which members interact on computers, allowing for anonymity of comments and aggregation of votes.



# Evaluating Group Effectiveness

| Effectiveness Criteria               | TYPE OF GROUP |                |          |            |
|--------------------------------------|---------------|----------------|----------|------------|
|                                      | Interacting   | Brainstorming  | Nominal  | Electronic |
| Number and quality of ideas          | Low           | Moderate       | High     | High       |
| Social pressure                      | High          | Low            | Moderate | Low        |
| Money costs                          | Low           | Low            | Low      | High       |
| Speed                                | Moderate      | Moderate       | Moderate | Moderate   |
| Task orientation                     | Low           | High           | High     | High       |
| Potential for interpersonal conflict | High          | Low            | Moderate | Low        |
| Commitment to solution               | High          | Not applicable | Moderate | Moderate   |
| Development of group cohesiveness    | High          | High           | Moderate | Low        |

Source: Based on J. K. Murnighan, "Group Decision Making: What Strategies Should You Use?" *Management Review*, February 1981, p. 61.

# Team vs Group

- ❖ *A team is “A small number of people with complementary skills who are committed to a common mission, performance goals, and approach for which they hold themselves mutually accountable”*
- ❖ *Thus while not all groups are teams, all teams can be considered groups*
- ❖ **Teams Vs groups: What is the difference?**  
**Discuss**